

John Radford

DevOps Engineer & Systems Programmer

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SUMMARY

DevOps engineer and systems programmer with 7+ years at a production web hosting company. Applies computer science fundamentals and insightful technical leadership to build internal tooling, automation, and secure infrastructure end-to-end, from distributed **KVM** clusters to custom **RAG** pipelines, with an emphasis on coding clean user experience for internal teams. Writes production **Perl**, **Python**, and **Go**. Mentors junior staff, admins Linux systems, and ships full-stack tools and applications.

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Perl, Python, GoLang, Bash, PHP, JS/TS
CI/CD & IaC Tools: Gitlab, Github Actions, Jenkins, Puppet, Ansible, Terraform
Web Frameworks: Perl PSGI, Perl Mojo, Python Flask, NodeJS, Go net/http
Operating Systems: Linux (RHEL/Ubuntu), FreeBSD

EXPERIENCE

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| DevOps Engineer & SysAdmin (Pittsburgh PA) | Pair Networks, Inc. | Jan 2023 – May 2026 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Built CI/CD pipelines with Puppet and Ansible (IaC/CaC/MaC), with monitoring via Icinga2 and ELK, deployed using GitOps.• Designed & built a Virtual Resource Manager (Perl) spanning 2 network segments, 40+ host systems, and thousands of guest VMs. Featured per-host REST API agents for CPU/mem/guest stats, a custom weighted-average rebalancing algorithm, and an interactive REPL CLI (vrnctl) for manipulating the QEMU/KVM clusters.• Developed a custom RAG pipeline (Python): ingested docs from GitLab, wikis, and knowledge bases; chunked, vectorized, and stored in ChromaDB; deployed tailored internal LLMs to assist support staff.• Built a centralized IP threat intelligence system: Perl modules querying 3 public threat intelligence APIs, persisted to a central store with Redis caching to eliminate redundant external calls.• Integrated Nginx/Apache rate limiting into the Puppet build system; built a quality assurance pipeline for false-positive monitoring, with graphing (GnuPlot), and threshold tuning.• Developed a KPI metrics pipeline: automated collection of core business metrics from billing and account systems into a central database, eliminating a recurring 1-2 hour manual reporting task each quarter.• Integrated CloudLinux into the legacy build system and Puppet; built LVE fault reporting tooling, custom control panel integrations, and an Ansible playbook for fleet-wide deployment.• Developed a centralized web statistics pipeline: Perl modules parsing raw access logs into structured JSON aggregated across the entire fleet via Ansible.• Automated SSL renewal notifications, replacing a manual process and saving an estimated 200+ hours (roughly \$10-15K) per year. | | |
| NOC & SOC Engineer (Pittsburgh PA) | Pair Networks, Inc. | Jan 2020 – Dec 2022 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Promoted to concurrent Security and NOC roles: monitored, detected, and remediated intrusions; triaged live production server incidents (hardware and software).• Simultaneously handled Level 2 support, abuse team, and internal account migrations tickets.• Helped maintain the internal ELK centralized logging stack and SOC/SIEM monitoring infrastructure. | | |
| Support Technician - Lvl 2 (Pittsburgh PA) | Pair Networks, Inc. | Aug 2018 – Dec 2019 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Resolved customer issues across web hosting (LAMP), email, DNS, domain registration, databases (MySQL), and PHP configurations.• Built deep Linux & FreeBSD hosting expertise across the full web stack that underpins all subsequent engineering roles. | | |

EDUCATION

Major: Humanities Gen (Philosophy, Art History, Classical Literature); Minor: Political Science (B.A.) GPA: 3.8	University of Pittsburgh - Greensburg	Aug 2014 – Dec 2017
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PROJECTS

Web-LGSM
A web portal for managing Linux game servers.
<https://github.com/BlueSquare23/web-lgsm>
Term::ReadLine::Repl
A batteries included interactive Term::ReadLine REPL module published to CPAN.
<https://metacpan.org/pod/Term::ReadLine::Repl>